

The Warplane Evolves

The 1930s saw rapid development in warplanes, especially from 1935 as the threat of war loomed. At the start of the decade, basic bombers and trainers looked much like late World War I aircraft, but soon monocoque fuselages, enclosed cockpits, all-metal construction, and advanced monoplane wing designs were the norm.

▷ Bristol Bulldog 1929

Origin UK

Engine 440-490 hp Bristol Jupiter VII supercharged air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 178 mph (287 km/h)

Frank Barnwell's design was the RAF's main day/night fighter between the wars. Cheap to maintain, it offered good speed, twin guns, and light bomb capability.



△ Polikarpov Po-2 1930

Origin USSR

Engine 125 hp Shvetsov M-11D air-cooled 5-cylinder radial

Top speed 94 mph (152 km/h)

The Soviets claimed that over 40,000 of Nikolai Polikarpov's Po-2s were built. Being surprisingly difficult to shoot down, in WWII they were trainers, night bombers, and reconnaissance and liaison aircraft.

◁ Dewoitine D27 1930

Origin France

Engine 425 hp Gnome-Rhone Jupiter VII air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 194 mph (312 km/h)

French aero-builder Émile Dewoitine moved to Switzerland in 1927 and designed this parasol-wing monoplane. Also built in Romania and Yugoslavia, 66 served with the Swiss Air Force.



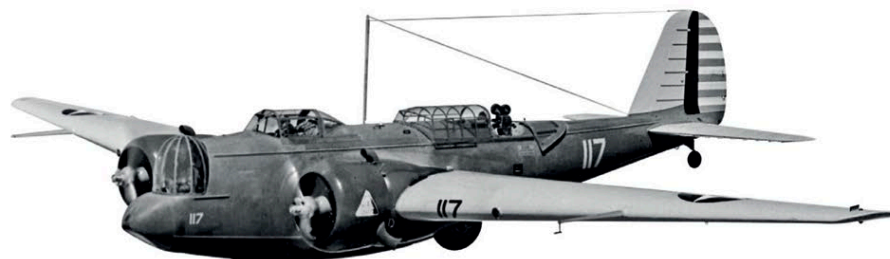
▷ Martin B-10 1933

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 775 hp Wright R-1820 Cyclone air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 213 mph (343 km/h)

The B-10 began a revolution in bomber design: it was the first US all-metal bomber, had the first gun turret, and was faster than fighters. It remained in production until 1937.



◁ Seversky P-35/AT-12 Guardsman 1935

Origin USA

Engine 1,050 hp Pratt & Whitney R-1830-45 Twin Wasp air-cooled 14-cylinder radial

Top speed 290 mph (467 km/h)

All-metal with retractable undercarriage and enclosed cockpit, the single-seat P-35 fighter was top of its class in 1935, but was soon outmoded. The two-seat AT-12 was a trainer development.



▷ Hawker Hurricane Mk1 1936

Origin UK

Engine 1,030 hp Rolls-Royce Merlin supercharged liquid-cooled V12

Top speed 328 mph (528 km/h)

Sydney Camm's Hurricane was an interceptor, fighter-bomber, night fighter, and ground-attack aircraft. It scored 60 percent of the victories in WWII's Battle of Britain.

